



Above In the old town, traditionally color-washed walls glow in the southern sunshine

Left The crescent-shaped city hugs the curve of the Baie des Anges – the Bay of Angels – backed by the soft contours of the Alpes-Maritimes



Above Today's chefs embellish the core niçoise ingredients with fresh herbs and blanched young vegetables such as green beans and baby leeks

Cooking Schools

Food writer and Cordon Bleu-trained cook Rosa Jackson runs **Les Petits Farcis** (www.petitsfarcis.com) from her restored 17th-century apartment in Nice's old town. Passionate about locally grown, organic food, Rosa dishes out cooking hints, recipes, and city tips during a class. Join her for a market tour, then learn to cook, then enjoy, a four-course niçoise lunch. Alternatively, stay in a farmhouse looking over the Côte d'Azur and learn to make tarts, tapenades, fragrant roast lamb, and other authentic Provençal goodies, or take a Nice food tour, with Tricia Robinson from **A Taste of Provence** (www.tasteofprovence.com). Programs run Apr–Jun, Sep, and Oct.

The Best Places to Eat Salade Niçoise

Bistro d'Antoine moderate

The outside terrace sheltering beneath a cheery red awning and the snug upstairs dining room of Bistro d'Antoine are unfailingly loaded with patrons, so chef Armand Crespo is definitely doing something right. Since he and his wife took over the bistro a few years ago, it has rapidly gained a loyal following, with locals and Nice blow-ins seduced by its breezy ambience and uncompromisingly seasonal, and suave, menu. It's the kind of place you wish was in every French town. Scallop carpaccio with slivers of turnip, lightly fried calamari with mixed wild leaves, lentils with plump sausages, and gravadlax with shaved fennel fresh from the morning market showcase the chef's technique and imagination. The salade niçoise is another winner. Naturally, there are the tiny black niçoise olives, tuna, anchovies, and, at the height of summer, tomatoes that taste of the Mediterranean sun. Depending on the market, fine slices of sweet red onion or tiny violet artichoke might make a guest appearance on the plate. The wine list also draws applause.

27 rue de la Prefecture, Nice; open noon–2 PM & 7:15–10 PM Mon–Sat; +33 4 93 85 29 57

Also in Nice

Acchiardo (+33 44 93 85 51 16; *moderate*) on rue Droite is one of those homey family-run concerns that seem so perfectly in tune with old-town surrounds. From its elbow-to-elbow tables to the blackboard menu touting “*cuisine nissarde*” (that’s “niçoise” in the local dialect), it’s honest and unassuming. The Acchiardo salade niçoise has the obligatory tuna, tiny black olives, eggs, tomatoes, and anchovies, often with a surprise from the morning’s market – maybe small red radishes or artichoke hearts.

Also in France

From April to October, **Plage 45** in the impeccably slick Grand Hotel at Cannes (www.grand-hotel-cannes.com; *expensive*) serves up salade niçoise with the works, all raw – not counting the hard-boiled eggs, tuna, and anchovies. That means cucumber, tomatoes, celery, red peppers, radishes, fava beans, black niçoise olives, and *cébette* (similar to leek but eaten raw), tossed with fresh basil.

Around the World

While French pastry great François Payard parades his favorite sweet treats at **François Payard Bakery** in New York’s Soho (www.fpbny.com; *inexpensive*), he also finds room for savorys, including a snap-fresh salade niçoise. It’s tweaked according to the season and dressed with a mustard vinaigrette, not olive oil, but tuna, hard-boiled eggs, plum tomatoes, and anchovies feature.